

FREE GUIDE · THE NO-CONTACT JOURNAL



Mindful No Contact

Short practices to calm the urge to reach out

digitaldisconnect.shop/guides/mindfulness-for-no-contact

The urge to text an ex often shows up in the body first: a tight chest, restless hands, a rush of adrenaline. Mindfulness and simple body-based (sometimes called "somatic") exercises can help you ride that wave without acting on it.

None of these require experience. Each one takes between one and ten minutes.

1. Urge surfing (5 minutes)

Instead of fighting the urge, observe it like a wave. Sit down, close your eyes and notice where you feel it in your body. Rate its strength from 1 to 10. Breathe slowly and keep watching as it rises, peaks and starts to fall. Rate it again at the end. Most urges drop noticeably within minutes.

2. Slow breathing (2 minutes)

Breathe in through your nose for a count of four, and out through your mouth for a count of six. Longer out-breaths can help your body shift out of "alarm" mode. Repeat for two minutes.

3. The 5-4-3-2-1 grounding exercise

- 5 things you can see
- 4 things you can feel (feet on the floor, clothes on your skin)
- 3 things you can hear
- 2 things you can smell
- 1 thing you can taste

4. Body scan for heartbreak (10 minutes)

Lie down and move your attention slowly from your toes to your head. Wherever you notice tension, like the jaw, shoulders or chest, breathe into it and let it soften a little. Heartbreak often sits in the chest and stomach, so spend extra time there.

5. Self-soothing touch

Place a hand on your chest or stomach, feel its warmth, and breathe slowly. It can feel odd at first, but many people find this simple gesture calming.

6. Name it to tame it

Say or write exactly what you feel: "I feel lonely and I want to hear their voice." Putting feelings into words can take some of their intensity away. Follow it with one line: "What I need right now is..."

Build a 10-minute evening practice

1. Two minutes of slow breathing
2. Five-minute body scan
3. Three minutes of writing: how today went and whether you kept no contact

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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